

ADHD diagnosis code usage in NHS England open SNOMED Code Usage in Primary Care data (2012-2025)

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Overview

This analysis explores code usage for SNOMED CT codes that may indicate diagnosis or administrative activity in the publicly available NHS England open SNOMED Code Usage in Primary Care data (2012-2025) from 1 Aug 2012 to 31 Jul 2025.

Methods

Data source

Data is taken from the [opencodecounts](#) R package.

Codelists

Two SNOMED CT codelists were created in OpenCodelists:

1. [ADHD diagnosis codelist](#): Codes that likely record a diagnosis of ADHD
2. [ADHD admin codelist](#): Codes that record administrative, referral, and assessment activity related to ADHD

Results

Usage data for ADHD diagnosis codelist

Total code usage for each code

Table 1 shows the total code usage (across all years) for each code. Borderline codes that may not be relevant for the thesis are highlighted in light blue. Note that the parent code ‘Disorders of attention and motor control 229712006’ is included but has no usage data. We may also want to consider if we are including codes related to drug treatment of ADHD.

Table 1: SNOMED CT diagnosis codes with total usage. Data source: NHS England [SNOMED Code Usage in Primary Care](#), Aug 2012 to Jul 2025.

SNOMED ADHD diagnosis code usage

snomed_code	description	total_usage
406506008	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (disorder)	2998560
192127007	Child attention deficit disorder (disorder)	74030
35253001	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, predominantly inattentive type (disorder)	57820
886371000000105	On drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (situation)	51180
31177006	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, combined type (disorder)	27120
702538008	Drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (procedure)	18345
702536007	Stimulant drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (procedure)	7260
192132008	Hyperkinetic conduct disorder (disorder)	5630
886391000000109	On stimulant drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (situation)	3820
229715008	Deficits in attention motor control and perception (disorder)	2050
7461003	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, predominantly hyperactive impulsive type (disorder)	1110
444613000	Adult attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (disorder)	830
886411000000109	On non-stimulant drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (situation)	590
229712006	Disorders of attention and motor control (disorder)	430
703314001	Non-stimulant drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (procedure)	360
117431000119101	Long term current use of drug therapy for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (situation)	295
192131001	Hyperkinesia with developmental delay (disorder)	220
702815001	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, inattentive presentation (restrictive) (disorder)	70
28271000087107	History of attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (situation)	20
46745001	Hyperkinetic syndrome with developmental delay (disorder)	5

Usage trends over time (top 5 codes)

Figure 1 shows that code usage increased sharply after 2021.

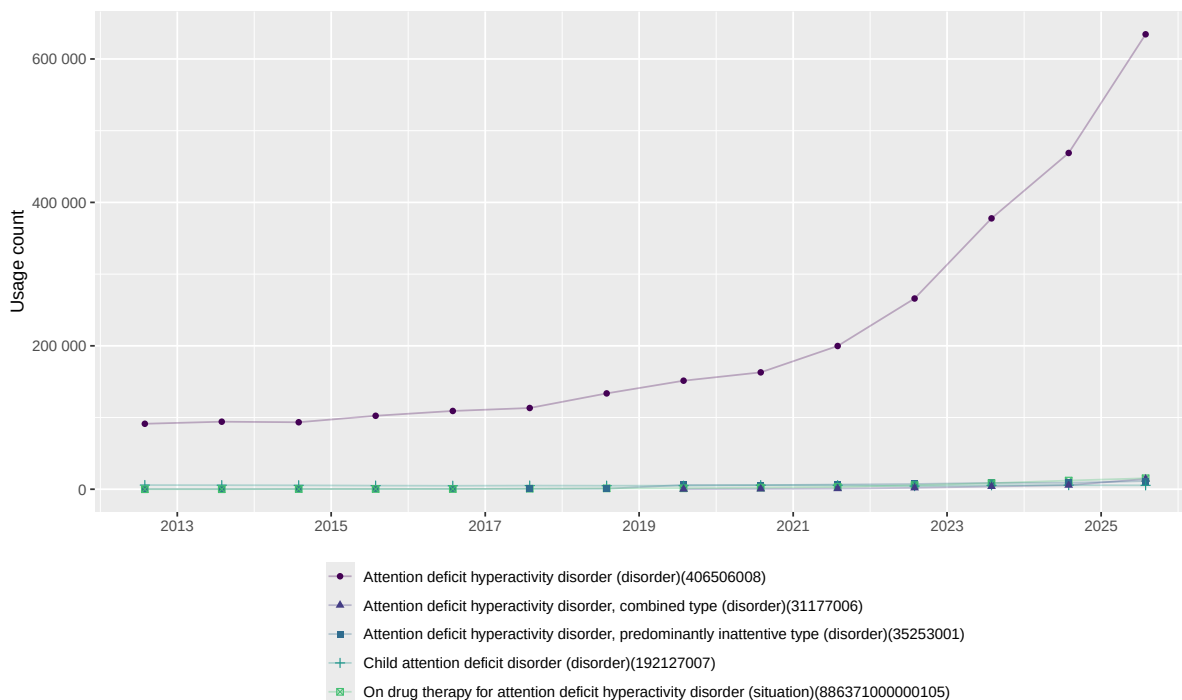


Figure 1: SNOMED CT diagnosis code usage over time. Data source: NHS England [SNOMED Code Usage in Primary Care](#), Aug 2012 to Jul 2025.

Usage data for ADHD admin codelist

This codelist contains codes related to referral, assessment, and administrative activity for ADHD, but not diagnosis or treatment.

Total code usage for each code

Table 2 shows the total code usage (across all years) for each code.

Table 2: SNOMED CT admin codes with total usage. Data source: NHS England [SNOMED Code Usage in Primary Care](#), Aug 2012 to Jul 2025.

Code	Description	Total usage
710071000000A06	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder annual review (procedure)	94,310
769390009	World Health Organization Adult Attention-Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder Self-Report Scale (assessment scale)	77,150
516401000000A06	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder monitoring invitation first letter (procedure)	35,150
191489100000D109	Diagnostic assessment for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (procedure)	22,640
243712100000R109	Referral for diagnostic assessment for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (procedure)	9,000
516891000000A01	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder monitoring invitation second letter (procedure)	5,210
516911000000A03	Attention deficit hyperactivity disorder monitoring invitation third letter (procedure)	1,180
242710100000S103	Signposting to attention deficit hyperactivity disorder resource (procedure)	140
712724008	Vanderbilt Assessment Scale (assessment scale)	80
709864005	Assessment using Vanderbilt Assessment Scale (procedure)	40

Usage trends over time (top 5 codes)

Table 2 show total code usage (across all years) for each admin-related code. Note that admin codes were not frequently used until around 2022, and some codes such as ‘Diagnostic assessment for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (1914891000000100)’ and ‘Referral for diagnostic assessment for attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (2437121000000109)’ first have activity recorded in 2024 and 2025 respectively.

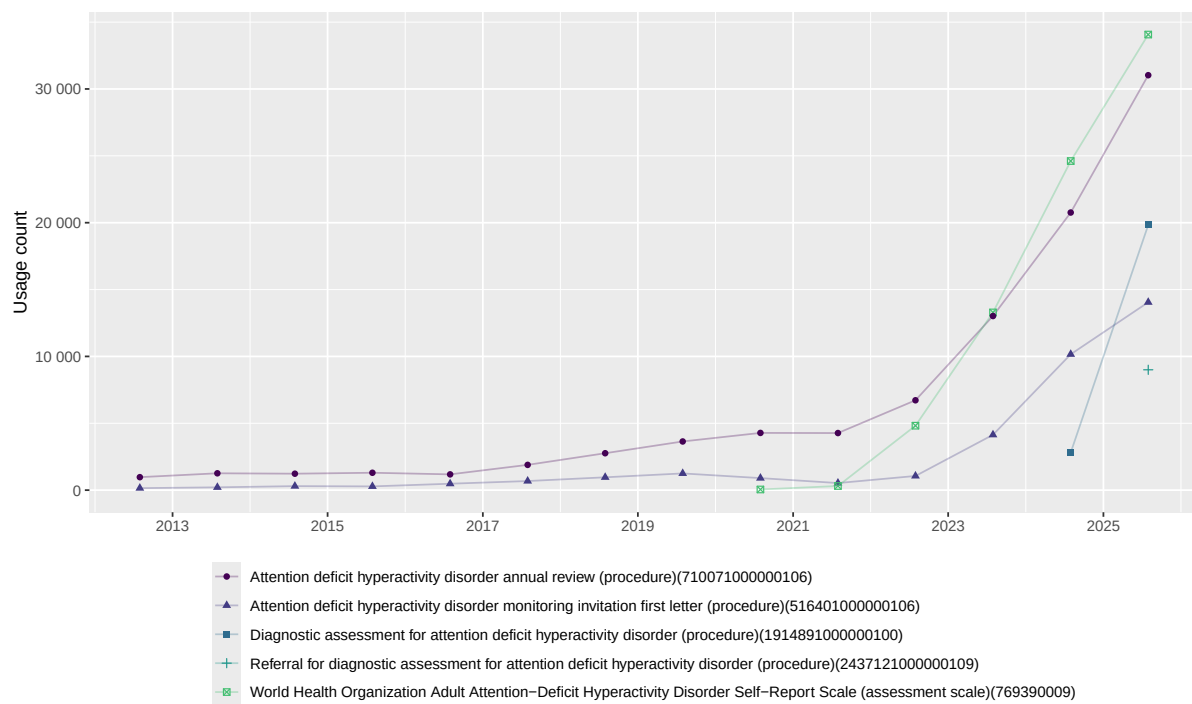


Figure 2: SNOMED CT diagnosis code usage over time. Data source: NHS England [SNOMED Code Usage in Primary Care](#), Aug 2012 to Jul 2025.